

Malek Mahmoud Hadi

Cybersecurity Specialist | Cybersecurity Engineer

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SUMMARY

I am a Cybersecurity Specialist with hands-on experience in web and network penetration testing, vulnerability assessment, and SOC operations. I have conducted authorized security assessments, identified security vulnerabilities, and built practical projects in threat detection, security monitoring, system hardening, penetration testing, and SOC analysis. I am always looking for new challenges and opportunities to grow and take my skills to the next level.

COURSES

Network & Windows & Linux & Cryptography Fundamentals

Web Development Basics (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP)

Python & C++ & MySQL Basics

Linux Basics for Hackers (book-based learning)

CCNA

CCNA Security

Cisco Cybersecurity Essentials

Cisco CyberOps Associate

eCIRv1

eJPTv2

eWAPTv2

OSCP

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Web Penetration Tester

05/2026 – 06/2026

Confidential Security Engagement

I conducted an authorized web penetration test and found an IDOR vulnerability due to broken access control, leading to unauthorized access to sensitive API data.

Network Penetration Tester

07/2026 – 07/2026

Confidential Security Engagement

I conducted an authorized black-box penetration test on an internal network and identified security weaknesses. I discovered and documented 25 findings ranging from Critical to Informational severity. I performed vulnerability validation, risk assessment, and provided remediation recommendations through a professional penetration testing report.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Cybersecurity

10/2022 – 06/2026

Al al-Bayt University

Graduated with Very Good academic standing (GPA: 3.46/4.00)

PRACTICAL PROJECTS

SQL Injection Detection

Technologies: PHP, MySQL

I built a web-based security tool that detects SQL injection attempts, temporarily blocks suspicious users, and logs security events. I also developed an admin interface for permanent IP blocking and unblocking.

Secure Project

Technologies: PHP, MySQL, RSA-2048, OTP Authentication, LSB Steganography, Admins, SQLI Detection

I developed a web application with OTP-based multi-factor authentication, RSA-2048 encrypted messaging, and LSB steganography for secure data exchange. The system also includes SQL injection detection with logging, automatic IP blocking, and role-based administrative access for security monitoring & management.

Snort Intrusion Detection Lab

Technologies/Tools: Snort, Linux (Ubuntu), VirtualBox

I built a Snort home lab with basic custom detection rules to monitor network traffic and generate real-time alerts for suspicious activity.

SOC Analyst Lab

Technologies/Tools: TShark, Zeek, Suricata, VirtualBox, Ubuntu, Windows, Nmap

I built a SOC home lab to simulate real network monitoring and threat detection using multiple virtual machines. The lab focused on packet capture with TShark, log analysis with Zeek, and real-time intrusion detection with Suricata to identify scans and suspicious network activity.

Hardening Linux Server

Technologies: VirtualBox, Ubuntu, Windows

I built a Linux server hardening home lab using CIS benchmarks, implementing auditd monitoring, UFW firewall rules, Fail2Ban protection, and secure SSH key-based authentication to improve system security and access control.

Hardening Windows 10

Technologies: VirtualBox, Windows

I built a Windows 10 hardening home lab using CIS benchmarks, implementing password policies, account lockout, UAC hardening, disabled unnecessary services, and Sysmon-based monitoring to improve endpoint security and detect suspicious activity.

DFIR Lab

Technologies/Tools: VirtualBox, Windows, FTK Imager, Eric Zimmerman Tools, CyberChef

I completed a DFIR lab (**KrakenKeylogger Lab**) from CyberDefenders simulating a data exfiltration incident and performed forensic analysis to reconstruct the attack timeline and identify the communication method and malicious activity.

Small Internal Network Penetration Testing Lab

Technologies/Tools: Nmap, Metasploit, Virtual Lab Environment

I built a home lab with three machines across two networks and performed internal penetration testing by exploiting a vulnerable host and pivoting to another system.

Remote Keylogger

Technologies: Python, pynput, SMTP, Visual Studio Code

I developed a remote keylogger and built a home lab to understand how keystroke monitoring works, including real-time data collection and sending captured data via email.

Web Exploitation — CYLab Security Academy / PicoCTF

Completed 24 labs (20 Easy, 3 Medium, 1 Hard)

Old Sessions, Crack the Gate 1, SSTI1, nos4n1ty 1, head-dump, Cookie Monster Secret Recipe, WebDecode, Unminify, IntroToBurp, Bookmarklet, Local Authority, Inspect HTML, Includes, Cookies, Scavenger Hunt, GET aHEAD, dont-use-client-side, logon, Insp3ctor, where are the robots, No FA, Hashgate, Secret Box, ORDER ORDER. Developed single-command curl PoCs whenever possible.

OffSec Proving Grounds

Penetration Testing Labs (13 Easy, 15 Medium, 2 Hard)

Successfully completed and documented **30 OffSec Proving Grounds labs**, covering Easy, Medium, and Hard difficulty levels.

Practiced end-to-end penetration testing methodologies, including reconnaissance, enumeration, vulnerability discovery, exploitation, privilege escalation, and post-exploitation.

Worked with a diverse range of real-world vulnerabilities and attack scenarios, including CVE-based exploitation, web application vulnerabilities, service exploitation, and Linux/Windows privilege escalation.

Documented the methodology, exploitation steps, findings, and remediation considerations for each completed lab.

Completed labs include: Fantastic, Kevin, Levram, Algernon, Slort, Astronaut, Exghost, Wheels, CVE-2023-6019, CVE-2024-25180, PyLoad, CVE-2024-48061, HUB, Detection, Twiggy, RubyDome, Sorcerer, Symbolic, Passport, PC, Press, BlackGate, Pathway, Jordak, Vault, Hutch, Nibbles, CVE-2023-46818, Snookums, and Fish.

SOFT SKILLS

- Attention to detail
- Ability to work in a team
- Adaptability to new tools and technologies
- Continuous learning mindset
- Communication skills
- Working under pressure

LANGUAGES

- Arabic: Native
- English: Good